



BRIEFING/MONITORING REPORT TO THE BOARD

DATE: November 16, 2022

TO: BOARD OF DIRECTORS, PUGET SOUND EDUCATIONAL SERVICE DISTRICT

FROM: JOHN WELCH, SUPERINTENDENT/CEO
PUGET SOUND EDUCATIONAL SERVICE DISTRICT

TOPIC: GOVERNANCE PROCESS (GP) 01: GOVERNANCE COMMITMENT

REPORT PURPOSE:

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ Policy Development/Review/Enhancement/Approval <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ Ends Policy and Sub-Ends Policy ☐ Executive Limitations Policy ☐ Board-Management Delegation Policy ☐ Governance Process Policy ☐ Board Implementation of Policy <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ Board-Management Delegation Policies ☐ Governance Process Policies ☐ Ownership Linkage Report | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ Board Monitoring CEO Report <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ Ends ☐ Executive Limitations ☒ Board Monitoring Board Report ☐ Board-Management Delegation Policies ☒ Governance Process Policies ☐ Incidental Report <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ☐ Superintendent ☐ Board Chair ☐ Other: Briefing Report |
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BACKGROUND:

POLICY TITLE: GP 01: Governance Commitment	POLICY NO: 01
POLICY SECTION: Policy Governance – Governance Process	
DATES REVIEW: Adopted – February 2001 Amended December 2005, June 2019 Last Monitored and Approved – Jan. 20, 2022; monitored but not approved Oct. 19, 2022 (policy was sent back to be strengthen with racial equity values. To be brought back to board in Dec 2022.) Policy approved December 14, 2022.	
BOARD POLICY REVIEW FREQUENCY: Every Year in October	
BOARD MONITORING CEO FREQUENCY: One Time a Year	
BOARD CHAIR SIGNATURE:	

Current Policy Language

BOARD POLICY GOVERNANCE POLICIES (GP) 01: GOVERNANCE COMMITMENT

We govern in a way that reflects our commitment to create racially just and humanizing school systems and become an Antiracist Multicultural Organization and board. We are committed to creating a racially just and humanizing educational system with equitable outcomes through our transformational relationships with K-12 education, early learning, higher education, families, and public and private organizations. PSESD Board and staff will take responsibility to do our best work in providing quality education, leadership, and service to and with our partners, motivated by a deep commitment to ensure that every child has the opportunity to reach their fullest potential.

PSESD recognizes the cultural abundance, wisdom, resilience, and achievement of our communities of color that have found ways to thrive despite the presence of historical and contemporary institutionalized and structural racism. It is our moral imperative to cultivate school systems that center the strengths of our communities, students, and their families and that maximize opportunities to build on those strengths. In partnership with our youth, families, and communities of color, we will create the conditions in our schools that will allow our students to flourish and thrive. To this end, we commit to governing in a way that uplifts the rich cultural and linguistic assets of our region's communities and centers the assets that have led to their resilience and thriving, despite the realities of persistent racial injustice that exist to this day.

We must be sensitive to, but not deterred by, varying levels of comfort of our partners grappling with the complexities of leading with racial equity. We also know that we must continue to interrogate our belief systems and improve our cultural proficiency order to increase our usage of practices that are evidence based and center the wisdom of the communities who are most impacted by educational injustice. We encourage our partners to do the same. PSESD must collaborate with our school district partners and those with whom we have transformational relationships, including our black, indigenous and communities of color by providing leadership and service to assure all schools in our region realize the vision of educational equity. Educational equity means uplifting cultural abundance of students while decreasing and eliminating the gaps. The concept of educational equity includes fostering a barrier-free environment in which all students, regardless of race, can benefit equally.

The historic and persistent opportunity gaps between racial and ethnic groups of students are deeply troubling and unacceptable. PSESD believes it is a moral imperative that we provide leadership with our partners to eliminate these inequities. A child's family and racial heritage should be considered assets that empower their success, not a predictor of their failure.

The PSESD Board will govern the success of the agency by listening, working together effectively, and providing strategic leadership to achieve board stated ENDS and avoid unacceptable actions and situations as outlined in board Executive Limitation policies.

Superintendent Interpretation & Action

RECOMMENDED MOTION

That the Governance Process Policy 01: Governance Commitment be approved as in compliance.